

File index — what every file is, and when to open it

All five workbooks are now real Excel Tables. Every sheet has sticky filter buttons with a search box in each dropdown, banded rows, frozen identity columns, and single-line rows so a screen shows ~30 programmes instead of 6. Click any header arrow to filter or search that column.

Everything produced by this search, in one table. **PDFs are in [pdf/](#) ; spreadsheets and markdown are in [results/](#) .**

Tier 1 — read these

File	Size	What's in it	Open it when
THE - COMPLETE - GUIDE .pdf	515 lines	The whole search explained. 1,091 opportunities · 56 countries. How the "chance of acceptance" column works and how it was validated · the 18 verified WORTH IT options · the accreditation trap in each country · the two separate tests (accreditation vs contact hours) that decide a visa · country-by-country cost table · the Italian DSU scholarship finding · scholarship comparison · your deadline calendar · what to do in the next month · an honest limits section	First. Before anything else. It is the map for every other file
MASTER-all-opportunities.xlsx	3.8 MB · 18 tabs	Every opportunity found, merged from all five searches. 1,091 rows × 36 columns. Tabs: <i>START HERE</i> · <i>BEST BETS</i> · <i>Strong + English or French</i> · <i>Fully funded</i> · <i>Has a scholarship</i> · <i>Scholarship index</i> · <i>Free or cheap</i> · <i>Everything</i> · then one per region (Western Europe, Southern Europe, Central Europe, Nordics & Baltics, Balkans & Türkiye, Eastern Europe & Caucasus, North America, Asia-Pacific, MENA). Colour-coded on chance, cost, language, public/private and funding	Whenever you want to decide something. Start on <i>BEST BETS</i> (140 rows), then filter <i>Everything</i>
PATHS-DEEP-DIVE .pdf	336 lines	What you'd actually study and become. The three career paths — sound & music tech, sound design & production, music business — explained in depth: the modules, the daily reality, the job you end up doing, and what each does <i>not</i> teach. Plus a full explanation of what a portfolio means in practice and how to build one	Before you choose a direction. The other files tell you <i>where</i> ; this tells you <i>what toward</i>

Tier 2 — the three regional deep dives

File	Size	What's in it	Open it when
EUROPE - GAPFILL.pdf + .xlsx	329 lines · 706 KB · 31 tabs	104 institutions the earlier searches missed , in 26 countries, searched in every local language. Contains your two best-rated options — TU Ilmenau and HfK Bremen . Documents that most German states charge non-EU students no tuition at all , that French public masters are a flat €3,950 , and that Greece charges no non-EU differential . Spreadsheet has a tab per country plus <i>No Portfolio Needed · English-taught · Free or Cheap</i>	You want cheap or free public options, or a specific country
PRIVATE - SCHOOLS.pdf + .xlsx	461 lines · 906 KB · 9 tabs	The "don't get scammed" document . 198 private institutions in Spain, Portugal, Netherlands, Italy — accreditation checked first. Which "Masters" are not degrees (<i>título propio</i> , CRKBO diploma, <i>Master di I livello</i>) · why the Netherlands is structurally closed to you · the Italian DSU scholarship worth €5,776–€8,134/yr at private academies · Saint Louis Rome. Spreadsheet tabs: <i>Official Only · Worth It · AVOID · Everything · one per country</i>	Before you pay any private institution a single euro
SOUND-DESIGN-EUROPE.pdf + .xlsx	125 lines · 589 KB · 8 tabs	The deep dive into your core subject . 319 programmes across every European country — conservatoires, film schools, private academies. The A-list of 13. Spreadsheet tabs: <i>A-LIST · All Programmes · No Audition · Accepts Non-Music · Fully Funded · By Country · Full Detail</i>	You want to go deep on sound design and production specifically

Tier 3 — planning and honesty

File	Size	What's in it	Open it when
ACTION-TIMELINE.pdf	76 lines	Month-by-month plan from now to September 2027 — portfolio milestones, language study, test dates, document preparation, application windows	You're ready to plan the year
SHORTLIST.pdf	130 lines	The earlier ranked shortlist of 12–15 programmes, each with its study location, fit score and reasoning	You want a short, opinionated list rather than a database
COULD-NOT-VERIFY.pdf	31 lines	Everything I could not confirm , listed openly — figures no institution publishes, dates that only exist for the prior cycle, claims that need an email to settle	Before you rely on any single number. This is the honesty file
README.md	20 lines	Short index of the folder	You're browsing the repo

Tier 4 — raw data and earlier snapshots

File	Size	What's in it	Open it when
<code>opportunities.xlsx</code>	1.1 MB · 546 rows · 9 tabs	The original worldwide sweep dataset, with its own fit-score and admission-difficulty columns. Superseded by the master file but kept intact	You want the first sweep on its own terms
<code>europe-gapfill.xlsx</code>	706 KB · 31 tabs	(also listed in Tier 2)	—
<code>console.html</code>	3.4 MB	An interactive browser for the same 1,091 records — filter, star, compare. Kept for completeness; the documents and workbooks above carry the same data	You'd rather click than scroll a spreadsheet

Everything is Excel now — the CSV duplicates were removed, and the raw JSON moved to `.masters-search/results/` . No data was lost: every CSV's rows were confirmed present in its workbook before deletion.

How the files relate

5 searches merged into explained by

worldwide sweep 539

deep Europe 102

sound design 319

private ES/PT/NL/IT

198

Europe gap sweep 104

→ MASTER-all-opportunities.xlsx → THE-COMPLETE-GUIDE.pdf

| 1,091 unique rows (read this first)

| 0 records lost

1,262 raw records each search also kept its own report:
EUROPE-GAPFILL · PRIVATE-SCHOOLS · SOUND-DESIGN-EUROPE

The three regional reports hold **more per-record detail** than the master file carries — full verification notes, complete fee breakdowns, portfolio specifications. The master file is for **deciding**; the regional files are for **checking a specific programme in depth**.

If you only have 20 minutes

- `THE-COMPLETE-GUIDE.pdf` the section **"What verification actually found"**
- `MASTER-all-opportunities.xlsx` tab **** BEST BETS filter** Taught in = English or French**

That is your real shortlist.